

Connecticut State Department of Education

DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2023–24



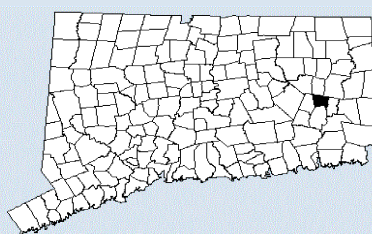
Sprague School District

William Hull, Superintendent • 860-822-8264 • <http://www.saylesschool.org>

District Information

Grade Range	PK-8
Number of Schools/Programs	1
Enrollment	291
Per Pupil Expenditures ¹	\$19,268
Total Expenditures ¹	\$7,553,191

¹ Expenditure data reflect the 2022-23 school year.



Community Information

AdvanceCT Town Profiles provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities at <https://www.advancect.org/site-selection/town-profiles>

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Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2023-24 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality. Complete data suppression guidelines are available at <https://tinyurl.com/SuppressionPolicy>

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

Students

October 1, 2023 Enrollment²

	District		State
	Count	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Female	135	46.4	48.3
Male	156	53.6	51.5
Non-Binary	0	0.0	0.1
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	0.2
Asian	*	*	5.2
Black or African American	*	*	12.5
Hispanic or Latino of any race	49	16.8	31.1
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	*	*	0.1
Two or More Races	43	14.8	4.7
White	187	64.3	46.2
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	11	3.8	10.5
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	162	55.7	44.0
Students with Disabilities ³	52	17.9	17.9

² This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

³ Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

	Chronic Absenteeism ⁴		Suspension/Expulsion ⁵	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	22	18.3	*	*
Male	32	23.2	*	*
Non-Binary	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
Black or African American	0	*	0	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	10	27.0	*	*
White	37	21.9	10	5.1
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	0	*	0	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	34	22.7	11	6.0
Students with Disabilities	21	45.7	*	*
District	54	20.9	14	4.5
State		17.7		7.0

Number of students qualified as truant under state statute: 67

Number of school-based arrests: 0

⁴ A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

⁵ This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

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Sprague School District

Educators

Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)¹ Staff

	FTE
General Education	
Teachers and Instructors	19.0
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	6.2
Special Education	
Teachers and Instructors	4.0
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	6.0
Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs	
District Central Office	0.5
School Level	2.0
Library/Media	
Specialists (Certified)	0.0
Support Staff	0.4
Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers	0.0
Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists	1.0
School Nurses	2.0
Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support	19.5

¹ In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

Educators by Race/Ethnicity

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
American Indian or Alaska Native	0	0.0	0.1
Asian	0	0.0	1.4
Black or African American	0	0.0	4.8
Hispanic or Latino of any race	0	0.0	5.1
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	1	3.7	0.1
Two or More Races	0	0.0	0.3
White	26	96.3	88.3

Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2022-23

	District	State
Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time	11.8	13.3

Instruction and Resources

Students Who Spend 80% or Greater Time with Nondisabled Peers²

	Count	Rate (%)
Autism	*	*
Emotional Disability	*	*
Intellectual Disability	0	0
Learning Disability	19	82.6
Other Health Impairment	13	*
Other Disabilities	*	*
Speech/Language Impairment	8	*
District	51	71.8
State		66.8

² This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

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Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability¹

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Autism	7	1.7	2.6
Emotional Disability	8	2.0	1.1
Intellectual Disability	*	*	0.6
Learning Disability	23	5.7	6.4
Other Health Impairment	19	4.7	3.5
Other Disabilities	*	*	1.2
Speech/Language Impairment	13	3.2	2.0
All Disabilities	79	19.4	17.3

¹ This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District²

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Public Schools in Other Districts	28	35.4	8.0
Private Schools or Other Settings	10	12.7	4.6

² This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Overall Expenditures³: 2022-23

	Total (\$)	Per Pupil	
		District (\$)	State (\$)
Instruction	\$5,418,394	\$13,822	\$12,942
Support services - students	\$214,065	\$793	\$1,724
Support services - instruction	\$167,928	\$622	\$905
Support services - general administration	\$232,954	\$863	\$520
Support services - school based administration	\$251,379	\$931	\$1,207
Central and other support services	\$165,179	\$612	\$771
Operation and maintenance of plant	\$427,926	\$1,585	\$2,101
Student transportation services	\$675,367	\$1,684	\$1,582
Food services	.	.	\$8
Enterprise operations	.	.	\$213
Total	\$7,553,191	\$19,268	\$21,143

³ Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

Special Education Expenditures: 2022-23

	District		State
	Total (\$)	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Teacher Salaries	\$213,266	8.3	27.6
Instructional Aide Salaries	\$155,161	6.1	10.2
Other Salaries	\$211,526	8.3	10.5
Employee Benefits	\$186,594	7.3	13.2
Purchased Services Other Than Transportation	\$213,521	8.4	6.4
Special Education Tuition	\$1,339,275	52.4	22.2
Supplies	\$6,503	0.3	0.7
Property Services	.	.	0.4
Purchased Services For Transportation	\$223,495	8.7	8.4
Equipment	\$6,478	0.3	0.3
All Other Expenditures	\$900	0.0	0.1
Total	\$2,556,720	100.0	100.0
Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education		33.8	25.0

Expenditures by Revenue Source⁴: 2022-23

	Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction
Local	53.1
State	38.8
Federal	7.8
Tuition & Other	0.2

⁴ Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2023-24

Sprague School District

Performance and Accountability

District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

	English Language Arts (ELA)		Math		Science	
	Count	DPI	Count	DPI	Count	DPI
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	*	*	0	N/A
Asian	*	*	*	*	0	N/A
Black or African American	*	*	*	*	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	26	53.9	26	41.6	*	*
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	*	*	*	*	0	N/A
Two or More Races	24	59.9	24	49.5	11	*
White	105	57.4	105	51.4	29	54.5
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	*	*	*	*	*	*
Non-English Learners/Non-Multilingual Learners	*	*	*	*	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	89	53.6	89	47.4	29	49.6
Not Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	74	61.1	74	51.9	21	58.5
Students with Disabilities	24	41.4	24	35.3	6	*
Students without Disabilities	139	59.7	139	51.9	44	55.7
High Needs	98	52.6	98	46.2	31	49.3
Non-High Needs	65	63.6	65	54.3	19	*
District	163	57.0	163	49.4	50	53.3

National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient¹

	NAEP 2022		NAEP 2013
	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
READING			
Connecticut	35	35	50
National Public	32	29	36
MATH			
Connecticut	37	30	32
National Public	35	26	25

¹ NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at

https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2022.pdf

Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard²

	Percent of Students by Grade ³ (%)				All Tested Grades	
	4	6	8	HS	Count	Rate (%)
Sit & Reach	82.1	87.9	87.5	N/A	85	85.9
Curl Up	53.6	75.8	100.0	N/A	85	75.3
Push Up	50.0	63.6	62.5	N/A	85	58.8
Mile Run/PACER	75.0	66.7	34.8	N/A	84	60.7
All Tests - District	39.3	48.5	*	N/A	84	38.1
All Tests - State	53.6	48.4	44.6	42.3		47.2

²The Connecticut Physical Fitness Assessment (CPFA) is administered to students in Grades 4, 6, 8 and High School (HS). The health-related fitness scores gathered through the CPFA should be used to educate and motivate children and their families to increase physical activity and develop lifetime fitness habits.

³Only students assessed in all four areas are included in this calculation.

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Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

Indicator		Index/Rate	Target	Points Earned	Max Points	% Points Earned	State Average Index/Rate
ELA Performance Index	All Students	57.0	75	38.0	50	76.0	63.9
	High Needs Students	52.6	75	35.1	50	70.2	54.1
Math Performance Index	All Students	49.4	75	33.0	50	65.9	60.2
	High Needs Students	46.2	75	30.8	50	61.6	49.5
Science Performance Index	All Students	53.3	75	35.6	50	71.1	61.8
	High Needs Students	49.3	75	32.9	50	65.8	51.4
ELA Academic Growth	All Students	52.8%	100%	52.8	100	52.8	58.7%
	High Needs Students	51.5%	100%	51.5	100	51.5	54.2%
Math Academic Growth	All Students	41.9%	100%	41.9	100	41.9	61.4%
	High Needs Students	40.8%	100%	40.8	100	40.8	55.1%
Progress Toward English Proficiency	Literacy	.	100%	.	.	.	58.9%
	Oral	.	100%	.	.	.	55.2%
Chronic Absenteeism	All Students	20.9%	<=5%	18.1	50	36.3	17.7%
	High Needs Students	26.0%	<=5%	7.9	50	15.9	25.5%
Preparation for CCR	% Taking Courses	.	75%	.	.	.	91.5%
	% Meeting Benchmark	.	75%	.	.	.	44.3%
On-track to High School Graduation		84.4%	94%	44.9	50	89.8	84.5%
4-year Graduation All Students (2023 Cohort)		.	94%	.	.	.	88.4%
6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2021 Cohort)		.	94%	.	.	.	86.6%
Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2023)		.	75%	.	.	.	68.4%
Physical Fitness (estimated part rate) and (fitness rate)		94.4% 38.1%	75%	25.4	50	50.8	93.6% 47.2%
Arts Access		.	60%	.	.	.	55.0%
Accountability Index				488.6	900	54.3	

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Gap Indicators	Non-High Needs Rate ¹	High Needs Rate	Size of Gap	State Gap Mean +1 Stdev ²	Is Gap an Outlier? ²
Achievement Gap Size Outlier?					N
ELA Performance Index Gap	63.6	52.6	11.0	16.9	
Math Performance Index Gap	54.3	46.2	8.0	18.2	
Science Performance Index Gap	.	49.3	.	17.9	
Graduation Rate Gap	.	.	.	.	

¹If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

²If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served. Gap calculations are based on unrounded rates.

Subject/Student Group		Participation Rate (%) ³
ELA	All Students	99.4
	High Needs Students	99.0
Math	All Students	99.4
	High Needs Students	99.0
Science	All Students	100.0
	High Needs Students	100.0

³Minimum participation standard is 95%.

Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

Grade 3 ELA Performance Index for Students with Disabilities:

District: * **State: 49.7**

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Sprague School District

Narratives

School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

Sprague Board of Education has developed a Strategic Plan to help maintain its focus on continuous improvement. To that end, grade level teachers have a daily common planning period to discuss classroom instruction and student achievement data. Administrators and teachers meet monthly by grade level to discuss student achievement and behavioral data. Professional Development for staff members is scheduled on a regular basis through the Professional Development and Evaluation Committee. There are also monthly faculty meetings held to disseminate and discuss important data points and other school events and activities that focus on continuous improvement. Data is analyzed at the district, school, grade and individual level. Teachers collaboratively use target strategies, including PBIS, to increase positive behavior and student achievement. The strategies include support for managing student behavior which minimizes disruptions to classroom instruction and helps children with challenging behaviors. SRBI meetings are held throughout the year with parents, administration, classroom teachers, support staff, and interventionists to monitor student achievement in math, language arts, and behavior. Students are supported through tiered interventions that target areas of need. Sayles School has an attendance team that meets weekly to look at attendance records and to identify students at risk for truancy. Meetings are held with families to discuss attendance concerns and to proactively put plans in place to increase attendance. Letters are mailed home to families to update them re attendance and tardy concerns. School staff and families meet to discuss student progress and make appropriate recommendations for the continued success of our students. After-school programs offer enrichment opportunities for students. Summer school sessions were provided for students who needed additional support during the regular school year. Continual assessment of progress coupled with data analysis and allocating staff to meet the needs of the district, allows the district to be flexible and to quickly adapt to student needs. After-school programs, including Sports Clubs, Chorus, Drama, and Art Clubs are available for students grades 3-8 to participate in during the school year. Sprague Board of Education has goals to encourage greater family involvement and communication. Activities held to meet those goals include: an opportunity to visit classrooms before school, a Meet-the-Teacher Open House Night, fall and spring parent-teacher conferences, an improved Sayles School website, concerts and plays open to the parents and the public, individual student team meetings with parents, administrators, teachers and other staff as appropriate, PPT and 504 meetings, preschool and kindergarten parent programs and visits, an active PTO which helps teachers with various tasks and supports student programs, use of a mass notification system, community events, regular family events, for example, early childhood education committee meetings, school-wide community outreach, and a Kindergarten orientation. Parents are offered PPT and Section 504 meetings in a variety of platforms: virtual, phone, and in person. The district's special education department hosted the Connecticut Parent Advocacy Center (CPAC) to present the ABC's of Special Education during a family dinner event.

Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

Sprague Public Schools continues to maintain an ongoing effort to reduce racial, ethnic, and economic isolation. Students attending Sayles School may attend our designated high school (Norwich Free Academy), and have the option to attend a number of technical or magnet schools in the area (Norwich Technical High School, Windham Technical High School, STEM Magnet Middle School, Charles Barrows STEM Academy, Regional Multicultural Magnet School, Winthrop Elementary Magnet School, and the Integrated Day Charter School.) Students may also attend the approved high school programs at Griswold High School in Griswold, Lyman Memorial High School in Lebanon, and Parish Hill High School in Chaplin, CT. The Sayles preschool program is accredited through the National Association for the Education of Young Children (NAEYC) and is accessible to students of all economic, racial, and ethnic backgrounds, including children with disabilities. Transportation is included for all preschool students. In addition, Sprague Public Schools has created and is implementing an Increasing Educator Diversity Plan with the goal to recruit, hire and select an outstanding staff that mirrors or exceeds the level of diversity of the student body. The research points to an improved learning environment for students, improved school behavior as well as improved student academic success as outcomes when this goal is achieved. This will lead to a stronger community where students can positively respond to future environments.

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Sprague School District

Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools

Sayles School and the Sprague Board of Education work tirelessly to provide a comprehensive and rich educational opportunity to its students in grades PK – 8. Resources are requested where needed and appropriated as approved by the Town. Students are provided numerous choices for their grade 9-12 education, including Norwich Free Academy, New London Science and Technology Magnet High School, Norwich Technical High School, Windham Technical High School, ACT Arts Magnet High School, Lebanon Regional Agricultural Science and Technology Center, Lyman Memorial High School, Parish Hill High School, and Griswold High School. Sprague also partners with students attending the two parochial schools in town (St. Joseph School in Baltic and Academy of the Holy Family in Baltic) for students requiring additional services in order to ensure all students who qualify for individual family service plans receive the services that they are entitled to.